



Helwan University
Faculty of Nursing
Community Health Nursing

Primary Health Care



Definition:

Primary health care seeks to extend the first level of the health system from sick care to the development of health.

Primary health care seeks to protect and promote of the community health through identify the population health problems at an early stage.

Primary health care services involve continuity of care, health promotion and education, prevention for individual and community.

The Primary Health Care Team

- 1- General & public health physicians.
- 2- Nurses
- 3- Dentists
- 4- Pharmacists.
- 5- Nutritionists
- 6- Community out reach workers.
- 7- Mental health counselors

Elements of Primary Health Care:-

1. Health Education program for common health problems.
2. Promotion of food supply and proper nutrition
3. The provision of safe water and basic sanitation.
4. Maternal and child health care including family planning
5. Immunization against the major infectious disease
6. Prevention and control of locally endemic diseases
7. Appropriate treatment of common diseases and injuries.
8. Provision of essential drugs.

Primary Health Care Sectors

- 1- Agriculture.
- 2- Industry.
- 3- Education.



Primary health care



- 4- Water and sanitary disposal.
- 5- Sanitation
- 6- Public work and communication.
- 7- Mass media.

Function of primary health care:-

- a. Promotive services.
- b. Preventive services.
- c. Curative services.
- d. Rehabilitative services.

Problems Facing primary health care:

1. Social Factors:

- a. Illiteracy & Lack of awareness of health aspects.
- b. Marriage of cousins.
- c. Early marriage
- Young age expectant mothers (16 yrs or less)
- Older or middle age expectant mother (35yrs or more).

2. Cultural Factors

3. Economic Factors:

- Limited financial resources.

4. Psychological Factors:

- Differential perceptions & concepts of health & illness.
- Fatalism, believing in fate & hopelessness.
- Language barriers.

5. Environmental Factors:

- Lack of water supply
- Poor sanitation
- Garbage spread every where

6. Situational Factors:



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- People may be geographically away or different to reach health centers.
- Transportation may not be accessible.

7. Communication & administrative Factors:

- Lack of communication between services (health personnel & public. Government & community).
- Bureaucracy.
- Lack of integration of health services.
- Lack of efficient referral system of supervision.

8. Inadequate Health Facilities:

- Equipment & supplies are deficient, out dated & broken.
- Lack of referral system & continuity of care.

9. Technology:

- Lack of equipment, supplies & teaching aids to apply procedures & techniques.

10. Education:

- Curriculums of schools of nursing don't put heavy emphasis on PHC.
- Lack of cooperation & collaboration between health services & educational institutions.

11. Personnel:

- Absence of community orientation of nurses.
- Shortage of qualified nurses.
- Problem in employing female nurses in isolated areas.
- Inadequate training programs which are not based on actual needs.

Role of the nurse in PHC:

A. General Duties:

1. Kind behavior with people.
2. Share people's needs.



Primary health care

3. Convey the message of the health centre to people in order to attract them.
4. Adapt with society.
5. Cooperate with other members of the health team.
6. Nice professional appearance.
7. Continuous aware with information & skills concerning health services.

B. MCH care including family planning:

- Mother care
- Child health care.

C. Communicable diseases care :

- Primary prevention.
- Secondary prevention.
- Tertiary prevention.

D. Proper nutrition promotion.

E. Home visiting.